

Question:

A 17-year-old teenager is brought to the emergency department with severe bleeding from his right hand. He was involved in a gang fight about 30 minutes ago where he received a penetrating stab wound by a sharp knife in the region of the ‘anatomical snuffbox’. A vascular surgeon is called in for consultation. Damage to which artery is most likely responsible for his excessive bleeding?

Answer Choices:

- A. Radial artery
- B. Ulnar artery
- C. Princeps pollicis artery
- D. Brachial artery

Reasoning + Answer:

<think> The anatomical snuffbox is a anatomical landmark located on the back of the hand, between the first metacarpal and scaphoid bone. It is commonly injured in stabbings and other sharp injuries, and the radial artery runs through it. Given that the injury is located in this region and he's bleeding severely, it is likely the radial artery was damaged.

</think>

<answer>A. Radial artery</answer>

